

Fed cuts key interest rate as labor market weakens

‘LET’S MAKE SOME NOISE’

The Cubs beat the Pirates to clinch the team's first postseason berth since the pandemic-shortened 2020 season, and the first in a full season since 2018. For the few holdovers from those teams, Wednesday's party was a long time coming. **Chicago Sports**



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Chicago Tribune



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THURSDAY, SEPTEMBER 18, 2025

BREAKING NEWS AT CHICAGOTRIBUNE.COM

Advocates outraged by raid of US citizen

Video from Elgin operation was shared online by Noem

By Angie Leventis Lourgos
Chicago Tribune

Local immigration advocates expressed anger and worry after a U.S. citizen was briefly detained — and footage of him handcuffed was posted on social media by a high-ranking member of the Trump administration — during a U.S. Department of Homeland Security raid on an Elgin home Tuesday.

Ismael Cordová-Clough, an Elgin immigration activist who witnessed the raid, said he was outraged that the operation was recorded and publicized online by the federal government, especially when one of the individuals captured on the footage was an American citizen.

“I think it’s disgusting, to be quite frank, that they utilized our community for their theatrics,” he said. “That is not putting our safety first. That is putting their show first.”

Early Tuesday, federal agents forcibly entered a home in the 900 block of Chippewa Drive in Elgin, destroying the front door and shattering a patio door in the process.

One of the residents in the home was Joe Botello, a U.S. citizen born in

Turn to Elgin, Page 5

TV commercial targets cops for ICE recruitment

By Jake Sheridan
Chicago Tribune

President Donald Trump is turning to the Chicago Police Department as he rushes to add immigration enforcement officers to carry out his administration’s mass deportation policy.

U.S. Immigration and Customs Enforcement is specifically pitching jobs to local cops in an ad that has been running on Chicago television.

“Attention Chicago law enforcement,” the commercial says, the city’s skyline in the background. “You took an oath to protect and serve, to keep your family, your city safe. But in sanctuary cities, you’re ordered to stand down.”

“Join ICE, and help us catch the worst of the worst,” it continues before touting a \$50,000 sign-on bonus and student loan forgiveness.

Asked about the ad Tuesday, Mayor Brandon Johnson called it “a horrible way to recruit,” but added, “I don’t sit around worrying about the president’s tactics.”

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CHICAGOLAND Female prisoners allege abuse at IDOC facility

Lawsuits from seven current or former inmates allege a widespread pattern of sexual abuse at Logan Correctional Center, followed by retaliation when they tried to report their experiences.

‘Diseases will return’

Fired CDC director issues dire warning at Senate hearing, tells lawmakers RFK Jr. rejected data on safety of vaccines

By Amanda Seitz and Mary Clare Jalonick | Associated Press

WASHINGTON — America’s public health system is headed to a “very dangerous place” with Health Secretary Robert F. Kennedy Jr. and his team of anti-vaccine advisers in charge, fired U.S. Centers for

Disease Control and Prevention chief Susan Monarez warned senators Wednesday.

Describing extraordinary turmoil inside the nation’s health agencies, Monarez and former CDC Chief Medical Officer

Chief Debra Houry described exchanges in which Kennedy or political advisers rebuffed data supporting the safety and efficacy of vaccines.

Monarez’s revelations to senators raised serious questions, even among some Republicans, about Kennedy’s self-professed commitment to employ “gold-standard science” for developing public health

Turn to CDC, Page 2

In suburban Wheeling, dueling petitions debate ‘day of honor’ for assassinated conservative activist who graduated there before becoming divisive public figure



AT KIRK’S HIGH SCHOOL, ECHOES OF DEEP SCHISM



By Rebecca Johnson and Joshua Irvine
Chicago Tribune

A debate reflective of the country’s political divide is unfolding at Wheeling High School, where groups are clashing over efforts to honor slain political firebrand Charlie Kirk, arguably its most famous graduate.

Students, parents and community members have begun signing dueling petitions on how to best memorialize Kirk, who was shot and killed at a Utah college event last week. One proposal requests a “day of honor” and a “notable alumnus” designation for Kirk, while the other tries to block the accolades and says

Clockwise, from top: A memorial honoring Wheeling High School graduate Charlie Kirk stands outside the school on Tuesday. Aleks Panek, 16, says he is in favor of the school honoring Kirk. Grace Mikhail, 17, says a “day of honor” would be unnecessarily divisive. **AUDREY RICHARDSON/PHOTOS FOR THE CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

people can pay tribute to him at one of the many public memorials.

Kirk, who was 31 when he was killed, often talked about how he developed his political views and honed his debating skills at the north-west suburban high school. In the days since his assassination, Kirk’s legacy has become the subject of public disagreement, with conservatives hailing him as a champion of free speech and liberals spotlighting his messaging that often incorporated racist, misogynistic and homophobic language.

On Friday, a group of parents started a petition

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